How to Record Names of Individuals

Use the name value with the NAME tag to provide the actual name of an individual. The following example (taken from the sample transmission on page 5-1) shows how name values provide the information indicated by the tag. These values can appear with varying level numbers.

1	NAME	John Quentin/Doe/

A name consists of a string of one or more name parts, separated by spaces, or by a slash (/) in the case of the surname. Capitalize the name of a person or place in the conventional manner--capitalize the first letter of each part and lowercase the other letters, unless conventional usage is otherwise. For example: *McMurray*.

Record the name pieces in the order they are spoken; the surname follows the given name(s), unless the name is traditionally spoken in some other order. The surname is immediately preceded and followed by a slash (/).

<u>Examples</u>

William Lee/Parry/	(*Parry* is surname)
William/Parry/Lee	(Surname *Parry* spoken in middle)
/Parry/	(No given names)
William	(No surname)
William/Lee Parry/	(*Lee Parry* is surname)

If diacritics or special characters are present in a name, preserve them in the manner referred to in chapter six, "Specification for GEDCOM Character Sets." Use ellipses--three periods (...)--to indicate missing or illegible name pieces. For example:

William Lee/Pa.../	(Part of surname is illegible)
William …/Parry/	(Second given name is illegible)

Names of individuals who were known by more than one name should be recorded in the manner shown below, using the tag for alias (ALIA):

0	INDI	
1	NAME	George/Lowther/
2	ALIA	Ned/Lowther/

How to Record Dates

Place the date in the same line as the DATE tag, immediately after the space following the tag. Dates are of two kinds: *regular* and *irregular*. They usually appear with the level number *2*.

Regular dates are bonafide dates from the conventional Gregorian calendar. Follow this procedure to record these dates:

29 FEB 1960	10 JAN 1802
1 JUN 1802	1802

Type the day (one or two characters) first, then the month (capitalize the first three letters of the English name of the month; do not use a period at the end), and then the year (four-character numeric year). The day and month may be omitted if unknown.

Irregular dates do not fit the regular date format. These include the following types:

- A date from a calendar other than the conventional Gregorian calendar. Identify this date with @#D and the name of the calendar.

  Examples: *@#DRoman@MDCCCXV*
  @#DHebrew@26TAM5442

- Pre-1752 English calendar

  Examples: *4/5 January 1751/52*
  24 7ber 1725

- Partial date (except where only the year is known; a year alone constitutes a regular date)

  Example: *5 June (year missing)*

- Illegible date.

  Example: *5 June (year present but illegible)*

- Ambiguous date

  Example: *7-12-84 (July 12th or December 7th?; 1984 or 1884?)*

- Approximate date

  Example: *Abt. 1850*
  Before 3 MAR 1913
  Between 1904 and 1905

- Date range

  Example: *From 1904 to 1905*

- Feast date

  Example: *2 days after Easter, 1690*

- Date before A.D. 1000

  Examples: *A.D. 962*
  600 B.C.

Irregular dates are typically treated as unformatted strings of characters. Record them exactly as they appear in the source. Here are examples:

How to Record Places (Localities)

A place name consists of one or more jurisdiction names (indicating one or more units in a political, ecclesiastical, or geographical hierarchy). Each jurisdiction name may consist of one or more name pieces (separated by spaces, such as *Idaho Falls*). Each name making up the full name is separated from the other by a comma (a space following each comma is optional).

The following examples (taken from the sample transmission on page 5-1) show how place names appear in a GEDCOM transmission. The level number for place names is usually 2.

2	PLAC	Illinois
2	PLAC	Idaho Falls, Bonneville, Idaho
2	PLAC	Iowa

Follow these three steps to record the names of paces:

1. Place the actual name of the place or locality in the same line as the PLAC tag, after the space that immediately follows the tag.

2. List the jurisdictions in order of increasing size, smallest first. The number of jurisdictions varies, depending on the source.

   - If an intermediate jurisdiction is known to exist, but its name cannot be determined, indicate its absence by using adjacent commas. For example, a city and state may be given, but not a county.

     Example: Green,, New York

- If the country referred to in the data, and the countries in which the data is prepared or used, are different, be sure the place name includes the country jurisdiction or an internationally recognized abbreviation, without periods.

  Example: Salt Lake City, Salt Lake, Utah, USA

3. Spell the name pieces exactly as they appear in the source.

   - Use the capitalization that appears in the source.

   - If a name listed on the original record appears to be misspelled, be sure to preserve this spelling. Do *not* change it.

     Green, Chenango County, Now York
     (Do not change *Now* to *New*; leave it *Now*.)

   - If part or all of a place name is illegible, use ellipses--three periods (…)--to indicate exactly what part of the name is illegible.

     Example: Green, ...ango County, New York

How to Record Events

Use the tag that is the name of the event you want to record, if the tag for that event is in the appendix. For example, use *BIRT* for *birth*. If the tag is not in the appendix, use the *event* tag--*EVEN*. Then specify the *name* of the event as the value. Dates and places of events are usually recorded as related GEDCOM lines. Here is an example of an event and related information:

```
1    BIRT
2    DATE    1836
2    PLAC    Illinois
2    EVEN    Service in World War II
2    DATE    12 Oct 1942 to 5 Aug 1945
```

How to Use Resource Identifiers

A resource identifier is a string of alphanumeric characters, all of which are capitalized. (See chapter three for more information.) This identifier is assigned by the Data Administration section of the Projects and Planning Division in the Family History Department.

Resource identifiers are the values that appear with the SOURce and DESTination tags in a GEDCOM header record. These values identify the source and destination systems. For each sending and receiving system, list the system ID and version number, if applicable, separated by a space.

In the example below (taken from the sample transmission on page 5-1), the resource identifiers are *PAF* (Personal Ancestral File) and *ANSTFILE* (Ancestral File). These identifiers always appear with the level number *1*.

```
0    HEAD
1    SOUR    PAF 2.1
1    DEST    ANSTFILE
```

How to Designate Time

Use the *time* value to identify when a request was sent. Be sure to use this value with the TIME tag. Time information is part of the header record (see chapter three for more information about the header). Follow these steps to designate time:

1. Place the time value--the actual time--in the same line as the TIME tag, after the space immediately following the tag.

2. Be sure to use 24-hour clock (military time) notation. Put the hour of the day first, then the number of minutes into the hour, and finally the number of seconds into the minute.

   Example

```
0    HEAD
1    SOUR    PAF
1    DEST    ANSTFILE
1    TIME    13:25:10
```

You may use the time value in other GEDCOM records if time needs to be identified. Time has been recorded in some birth records, and can be identifed with use of the TIME tag on a level supportive of 'the BIRTH or other event-type tag.

Example

```
1    BIRT
1    DATE    12 June 1950
1    TIME    14:53
```

How to Use Pointers

Use pointers to show how information in one or more lines of a GEDCOM transmission is related to information in another line of the same transmission.

- Use each pointer with the tag and level number that corresponds to the appropriate line of information.

- Be sure the pointer follows the tag in the same line and appears after the space immediately following the tag.

- Begin and end each pointer with the delimiter symbol(@).

Examples:	@121@	@DE@
	@X-x@	@F1-1@

Pointers must be unique within a single GEDCOM transmission. Each pointer must contain exactly the same characters as its corresponding cross-reference identifier (which occurs only once in the cross-reference identifier column) in order to "point" to the desired relationship. Multiple (identical) pointers can appear in the same record to point to the same cross-reference identifier.

In the example below (taken from page 5-1), the pointer *@1@* in the HUSBAND tag in the second line of the family record refers to the individual whose name is *John Quentin Doe* in the first individual record. The pointer *@1@* points to the cross-reference identifier *@1@* to show this relationship. The characters for the pointer and the cross-reference identifier are identical.

0	@1@	INDI	
1		NAME	John Quentin/Doe/
0	@4@	FAM	
1		HUSB	@1@

You can use most alpha, numeric, or other characters to create pointers--including your computer's own native keys, or record numbers from its internal data base structure. You cannot, however, use the following three characters:

- @ (the delimiter symbol)
- # (the number sign, also known as the U.S. pound sign, which is code 35)
- The terminator symbol (see page 5-9 for information about the terminator)

How to Use Other Values

<u>Character Set</u>

Two standard character sets are used most often for GEDCOM transmissions: 8-Bit ANSEL and ASCII (USA version) (ANSI 8 Bit). The default charcter set is 8-Bit ANSEL--*Extended Latin Alphabet Coded Character Set for Bibliographic Use* (American National Standards (ANSI) Z39.47-1985)--because it handles a wider variety of diacritics and special characters than any other character set.

If your transmission does not require diacritics, you may wish to use ASCII (USA version) (ANSI 8 Bit), if your computer already supports it. In the future, you will be able to use the binary character set to facilitate transmission of photographs and other bit-mapped graphics. Other character sets can also be used for the transmissions. You will find more information about character sets in chapter six, "Specification for GEDCOM Character Sets."

You can change the character set any time in any system associated with any data. To change the character set, follow the procedure in chapter six, on page 6-2.

Length

You can use *length* to indicate the length of a value. Length contains the count of the characters present in the value. Follow these steps to indicate length:

1. Start with @# (the escape-sequence symbol).
2. Then type an *L* and the numbers specifying the actual length.
3. End with @ (the delimiter symbol), if present. It does not have to be present for binary data (see page 6-2 and 6-3 for more information).

   Example: @#L123@ (The length specified is 123 characters.)

Length allows a program to skip directly to the end of a line without scanning each character for the terminator symbol. A line must contain either the length or the terminator symbol (and may contain both) to indicate where the end of the GEDCOM line occurs. If a line contains both, the value of length includes the terminator.

Terminator

The terminator marks the end of a GEDCOM line--it separates one line from another. A terminator (not visible on the screen) produces a line feed. In ANSEL, the terminator symbol is the line feed (decimal code 10 or hex code 0A) or carriage return (decimal code 13 or hex code 0D), or a combination of the two. In the sample transmission on page 5-1, the terminator is an invisible carriage-return character.

A GEDCOM line must contain a length or a terminator, or both. This makes it possible for you to scan the line with the use of *length* and read the line because of the action of printing the line-feed for the terminator. If a line contains both, the value of length includes the terminator. The terminator cannot occur as data in a value if the length field is not used.

Calendar

You specify a calendar for a date by following these three steps:

1. Start with the escape sequence indicator (@#) and a *D*.
2. Type the name of the calendar.
3. End the designation with the terminator @.

Example: @#DHEBREW@ (Designation for the Hebrew calendar.)

For further information about approved calendars, contact Data Administration in the Projects and Planning Division of the Family History Department.

Chapter 6

SPECIFICATION FOR GEDCOM CHARACTER SETS

Introduction

This chapter lists and explains the character sets that can be used with GEDCOM. It also provides the escape sequences and conventions required to change from one character set to another during a transmission.

This specification does not include implementation methods for multilingual processing, such as keyboard arrangements, sorting sequences, or character and graphic representations (font styles, proportional spacing, etc.) on the CRT or printers.

Why Various Character Sets Are Used

GEDCOM accommodates several standard character sets to facilitate the sharing of diverse genealogical data in many different languages, and to meet different user needs. These character sets are listed and explained below.

8-Bit ANSEL--The Default Character Set

The 8-Bit ANSEL (*American National Standard for Extended Latin Alphabet Coded Character Set for Bibliographic Use, Z39.47, 1985 copyright*) is the default character set for GEDCOM. It is used for all transmissions of information, unless another character set is specified.

The 8-Bit ANSEL is a standard of the American National Standards Institute (ANSI). It is the only character set that will handle a wide variety of diacritics and special characters for Romanized languages. (A diacritic is a graphic mark, point, or sign used with alphabetic graphic characters to distinguish them by form or sound.) GEDCOM accommodates all diacritics that are included in Family History Department computer systems text and bibliographic information. Use the 8-Bit ANSEL character set when your transmission must preserve the full integrity of original Roman-alphabetic languages, including diacritics and special characters.

The 8-Bit ANSEL is also known by three other names: (1) the official name Extended *Latin Alphabet Coded Character Set for Bibliographic Use* (American National Standards (ANSI) Z39.47-1985); (2) American Library Association character set, widely used in library systems; and (3) MARC (Machine-Readable Catalog).

You will find the standard for 8-Bit ANSEL on the last five pages of this chapter. It is reproduced with permission from the American National Standards Institute. Copies of this character set may be purchased from the American National Standards Institute at 1430 Broadway, New York, N.Y. 10018.

The standard for 8-Bit ANSEL includes the following:

- An 8-Bit Code Table consisting of ANSEL and ASCII codes (see page 6-5)
- An explanation of the codes (see page 6-6)
- ANSEL Nonspacing Graphic Characters (see page 6-7)
- ASCII Control Characters (see page 6-8)
- ASCII Graphic Characters (see page 6-9)

The 8-Bit Code Table consists of characters *0* through *127*, which are the same for 8-Bit ANSEL and 8-Bit ASCII (USA version) (ANSI 8 Bit). Character-set characters *128* through *255* are unique to the ANSEL character set.

ASCII (USA version) (ANSI 8 Bit)

If you have no need for diacritics or special characters, and if you are not transmitting binary data, you will find it convenient to use ASCII (USA version) (ANSI 8 Bit) if your computer already supports it. This is a standard of the American National Standards Institute (ANSI). Most of the normal printable characters of ANSEL and ASCII (USA version) are identical.

Binary and Other Character Sets

In the future, you will be able to use the binary formats for transmission of photographs and other bit-mapped graphics. Other character sets are registered with the Technology and Architecture Section of the Family History Department. You may contact this section for additional character sets.

How to Change Character Sets

The procedure for changing character sets depends on whether you wish to change the character set for an entire transmission, or for just part of a transmission.

<u>For an Entire Transmission</u>

To change the character set for an entire transmission, do two things:

- Specify the new character set in the character set line of the header record. (For more information about the header record, see chapter three.)

- Use the one-word name of the character set you want, following the CHAR tag in the same line.

The example below shows the specification in the header record.

0	HEAD	
1	SOUR	PAF 2.1
1	DEST	ANSTFILE
1	CHAR	ASCII

<u>For Part of a Transmission</u>

To change the character set for part of a transmission, follow this procedure:

1. Select the approved one-word name of the character set you want for your transmission. GEDCOM transmissions are automatically sent in 8-Bit ANSEL, unless you specify another character set. Following are the one-word names used for the default character set and the other two mentioned above.

   - ANSEL. 8-Bit ANSEL character set (default)
   - ASCII. ASCII (USA version) (ANSI 8 Bit)
   - BINARY. Binary data (future use)

2. Make sure the character set appears in the value column, on the same line as the rest of the data for the character set.

   Example: *@#CASCII@*. This is the designation for the character set for ASCII (USA version) with the symbols that begin and end it.

3. Designate the character set. Begin with the escape-sequence symbol followed by *C*. The escape-sequence symbol is a combination of @ and # (@#). Then type the name of the character set. End the designation with @ (the terminator), as shown below.

@#CANSEL@	8-Bit ANSEL character set (default)
@#CASCII@	ASCII (USA version) (ANSI 8 Bit)
@#CBINARY@	Binary data (future use)

   The first three characters--*@#C*--alert the computer that information will be sent or received in a new character set. The actual change in character set starts with the first character that follows the closing @. This change is in effect until the length indicated has been reached, the end-of-transmission symbol (TRLR) has been encountered, or another change in character set is specified.

If you are using the default character set (8-Bit ANSEL), make sure that all diacritic and special characters immediately precede the character they are to be associated with. If you are using a character set other than ANSEL, or if the data must change from one character set to another, indicate the change by using a *character-set change escape sequence*.

Example: (space)@#CASCII:123@

Note that the length (123) follows the colon. The escape sequence is *context insensitive* and may appear anywhere, as many times as needed.

For more information about character sets, see the following:

- Genealogical Department Internal Memorandum, from GIS Administrative Council to GIS User's Committee Regarding Diacritics and the Genealogical Information System. 13 January 1986.

- *Extended Latin Alphabet Coded Character Set for Bibliographic Use*. American National Standards (ANSI) Z39.47, 1985.

- 8-*Bit ASCII--Structure and Rules."* American National Standards (ANSI) X3.134.1-198x.

- "7-Bit and 8-Bit ASCII Supplemental Multilingual Graphic Character Set (ASCII Multilingual Set)" (manuscript). American National Standards (ANSI), X3.134.2-198x.

4321 BITS		0000 0	0001 1	0010 2	0011 3	0100 4	0101 5	0110 6	0111 7	1000 8	1001 9	1010 10	1011 11	1100 12	1101 13	1110 14	1111 15 (8765 BITS)
0000	0	NUL	DLE	SP	0	@	P	` *	P				ʿ	°		˺	˻
0001	1	SOH	DC1	!	1	A	Q	a	q			Ł	ł	ℓ		ˋ	ˏ
0010	2	STX	DC2	"	2	B	R	b	r			Ø	ø	℗		´	ˎ
0011	3	ETX	DC3	#	3	C	S	c	s			Đ	đ	©		ˆ	ˍ
0100	4	EOT	DC4	$	4	D	T	d	t			Þ	þ	♯		˜	˚
0101	5	ENQ	NAK	%	5	E	U	e	u			Æ	æ	¿		¯	˸
0110	6	ACK	SYN	&	6	F	V	f	v			Œ	œ	¡		˘	—
0111	7	BEL	ETB	´	7	G	W	g	w			'	"			˙	ˌ
1000	8	BS	CAN	(	8	H	X	h	x			·	ı			¨	˹
1001	9	HT	EM	)	9	I	Y	i	y			ȸ	£			ˇ	˽
1010	10	LF	SUB	*	:	J	Z	j	z			®	ð			˚	˼
1011	11	VT	ESC	+	;	K	[	k	{			±				˛	˻
1100	12	FF	FS	,	<	L	\	l	|			Ơ	ơ			˺	
1101	13	CR	GS	-	=	M	]	m	}			Ư	ư			ˈ	
1110	14	SO	RS	.	>	N	^ *	n	~ *			'				˝	ˈ
1111	15	SI	US	/	?	O	_ *	o	DEL							˚	

*Redefined in the extended Latin alphabet coded character set.

Reserved for control characters.

Reserved for future standardization.

Corners (Reserved).

Explanation of Codes for the 8-Bit Code Table

NOTE: The legend for ASCII character in 6.3 and 6.4 is adapted from ANSI X3.4-1977. For complete information of the use of ASCII refer to the latest edition of that standard.

6.1 ANSEL Spacing Graphic Characters

7-Bit Col/Row	8-Bit Col/Row	Graphic	Name	Example of Use
2/1	10/1	Ł	slash L - uppercase	Łódź
2/2	10/2	Ø	slash O - uppercase	Øst
2/3	10/3	Đ	slash D - uppercase	Đuro
2/4	10/4	Þ	thorn - uppercase	Þann
2/5	10/5	Æ	ligature AE - uppercase	Ægir
2/6	10/6	Œ	ligature OE - uppercase	Œuvre
2/7	10/7	′	mi͡agkiĭ znak	Fakul′tet
2/8	10/8	·	middle dot	novel·la
2/9	10/9	♭	musical flat	B♭
2/10	10/10	®	patent mark	ABC®
2/11	10/11	±	plus or minus	A±B
2/12	10/12	Ȯ	hook O - uppercase	BȮ
2/13	10/13	Ư	hook U - uppercase	XƯA
2/14	10/14	’	alif	Un’yusho
3/0	11/0	‘	‘ayn	fa‘il
3/1	11/1	ł	slash l - lowercase	rozbił
3/2	11/2	ø	slash o - lowercase	Høj
3/3	11/3	đ	slash d - lowercase	đavola
3/4	11/4	þ	thorn - lowercase	Þann
3/5	11/5	æ	ligature ae - lowercase	skæg
3/6	11/6	œ	ligature oe - lowercase	œuvre
3/7	11/7	″	tvërdyĭ znak	ob″i͡avlenie
3/8	11/8	ı	dotless i - lowercase	masalı
3/9	11/9	£	British pound	£5.00
3/10	11/10	ð	eth	verður
3/12	11/12	ơ	hook o - lowercase	Sở
3/13	11/13	ư	hook u - lowercase	Tư Dưc
4/0	12/0	°	degree sign	10°C
4/1	12/1	ℓ	script l[2]	25 ℓ
4/2	12/2	℗	phonograph record copyright mark	Decca ℗
4/3	12/3	©	copyright symbol	© 1974
4/4	12/4	♯	musical sharp	D♯
4/5	12/5	¿	inverted question mark	¿Qué?
4/6	12/6	¡	inverted exclamation mark	¡Esta!

[2] In bibliographic work, the script l, ℓ, is commonly used as an abbreviation for the term “leaves.” It shall not be used as a symbol for the unit of measure “liter.”

ANSEL Nonspacing Graphic Characters

7-Bit Col/Row	8-Bit Col/Row	Graphic	Name	Example of Use
6/0	14/0	̉	low rising tone mark	củi
6/1	14/1	̀	grave accent	règle
6/2	14/2	́	acute accent	está
6/3	14/3	̂	circumflex accent	même
6/4	14/4	̃	tilde	niño
6/5	14/5	̄	macron	gājējs
6/6	14/6	̆	breve	altă
6/7	14/7	̇	dot above	żaba
6/8	14/8	̈	umlaut (diaeresis)	öppna
6/9	14/9	̌	háček	vždy
6/10	14/10	̊	circle above (angstrom)	hår
6/11	14/11	͡	ligature, left half	akademii͡a
6/12	14/12	͜	ligature, right half	akademii͜a
6/13	14/13	̓	high comma, off center	rozdel̓ovac
6/14	14/14	̋	double acute accent	időszaki
6/15	14/15	̐	candrabindu	Ali̐ev
7/0	15/0	̧	cedilla	ça
7/1	15/1	̨	right hook	vietą
7/2	15/2	̣	dot below	teḍa
7/3	15/3	̤	double dot below	khuṭbah
7/4	15/4	̥	circle below	Maharṣicāritamr̥tam
7/5	15/5	̳	double underscore	G̳hulam
7/6	15/6	̲	underscore	s̲amar
7/7	15/7	̦	left hook	darziṇa
7/8	15/8	̩	right cedilla	khọng
7/9	15/9	̪	half circle below (upadhmaniya)	ḫumantuš
7/10	15/10	̠	double tilde, left half	ñgalan
7/11	15/11	̡	double tilde, right half	ñgalan
7/14	15/14	̔	high comma, centered	ge̓otermika

ASCII Control Characters

Col/ Row	Mnemonic and Meaning		Col/ Row	Mnemonic and Meaning	
0/0	NUL	Null	1/0	DLE	Data Link Escape
0/1	SOH	Start of Heading	1/1	DC1	Device Control 1
0/2	STX	Start of Text	1/2	DC2	Device Control 2
0/3	ETX	End of Text	1/3	DC3	Device Control 3
0/4	EOT	End of Transmission	1/4	DC4	Device Control 4
0/5	ENQ	Enquiry	1/5	NAK	Negative Acknowledge
0/6	ACK	Acknowledge	1/6	SYN	Synchronous Idle
0/7	BEL	Bell	1/7	ETB	End of Transmission Block
0/8	BS	Backspace	1/8	CAN	Cancel
0/9	HT	Horizontal Tabulation	1/9	EM	End of Medium
0/10	LF	Line Feed	1/10	SUB	Substitute
0/11	VT	Vertical Tabulation	1/11	ESC	Escape
0/12	FF	Form Feed	1/12	FS	File Separator
0/13	CR	Carriage Return	1/13	GS	Group Separator
0/14	SO	Shift Out	1/14	RS	Record Separator
0/15	SI	Shift In	1/15	US	Unit Separator
			7/15	DEL	Delete

ASCII Graphic Characters

Col/Row	Graphic	Name
2/0	SP	Space (Normally Nonprinting)
2/1	!	Exclamation Point
2/2	"	Quotation Marks (Diaeresis)
2/3	#	Number Sign
2/4	$	Dollar Sign
2/5	%	Percent Sign
2/6	&	Ampersand
2/7	´	Apostrophe (Closing Single Quotation Mark; Acute Accent)
2/8	(	Opening Parenthesis
2/9	)	Closing Parenthesis
2/10	*	Asterisk
2/11	+	Plus
2/12	,	Comma (Cedilla)
2/13	-	Hyphen (Minus)
2/14	.	Period (Decimal Point)
2/15	/	Slant
3/0 to 3/9	0 … 9	Digits 0 through 9
3/10	:	Colon
3/11	;	Semicolon
3/12	<	Less Than
3/13	=	Equals
3/14	>	Greater Than
3/15	?	Question Mark
4/0	@	Commercial At
4/1 to 5/10	A … Z	Uppercase Latin Letters A through Z
5/11	[	Opening Bracket
5/12	\	Reverse Slant
5/13	]	Closing Bracket
5/14	^	Circumflex
5/15	_	Underline
6/0	`	Opening Single Quotation Mark (Grave Accent)
6/1 to 7/10	a … z	Lowercase Latin Letters a through z
7/11	{	Opening Brace
7/12	|	Vertical Line
7/13	}	Closing Brace
7/14	~	Tilde

Chapter 7

SPECIFICATION FOR GEDCOM TRANSMISSION MEDIA

Introduction

This chapter specifies GEDCOM transmission media. It lists the media that can be used to send genealogical information from one computer to another (within the Family History Department of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints), and describes how the media itself is physically organized to carry the data. Media used by communicating systems outside the department are not limited to this list.

The specification for GEDCOM transmission media is for three major uses:

- Interfaces between all Family History Department data-processing applications using the GEDCOM format

- Other applications that interface with Family History Department applications using the GEDCOM format

- Computer media that use GEDCOM format for archiving data from Family History Department applications

This chapter does not address the content of application messages or character sets used to represent data. See chapter six for information about character sets.
Additional information about the specification for GEDCOM transmission media is in these documents: "Information Systems Practice 202: Data Communications Standards" and "Information Systems Practice 203: Information Systems Hardware and System Software Product Shopping List Standard." You will find these in *Information Systems Practices*, a manual in the Information Systems Department library (on Floor 19 of the Church Office Building of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints,
50 East North Temple, Salt Lake City, Utah).

When transferring data in GEDCOM format, sending and receiving systems must agree to use one or more of the media listed in this chapter.

Diskettes

<u>3 1/2" Floppy Diskette</u>

- 720K formatted capacity diskette constructed and formatted for use in the IBM PC Convertible lap top computer running MS DOS 3.2 and -the IBM PS2 computer
- 1.44M formatted diskette for the MS DOS
- 400K and 800K formatted Apple Macintosh diskette

5 1/4" Floppy Diskette

- 360K formatted capacity diskette constructed and formatted for use in the IBM PC standard desk top computer running MS DOS
- 1.2M formatted capacity diskette constructed and formatted for use in the IBM PC AT desk top computer running MS DOS
- 124K (16 sector) formatted capacity diskette constructed and formatted for use in the Apple II family of computers running Apple DOS 3.3
- 191K single-sided, double-density capacity diskette constructed and formatted for use in the Kaypro family of computers running CP/M

5 1/4" Iomega 20 Megabyte Cartridge

Compact Disc

5 1/4" CD-ROM (compact disc read-only memory). This has 650-megabyte storage capability.

Tape

1/2" magnetic tape. This includes two kinds:

A 9-track, 1600 BPI, unlabeled, phase-encoded magnetic tape
A 9-track, 6250 BPI, labeled, group-coded recording (GCR) magnetic tape

Electronic Communications

Electronic communications consists of the transferring of information between two separate computer systems via a direct, electrical connection.

The requirements for electronic communications are specified in the manual *Information Systems Practices*, Practices 202 and 203, of the Information Systems Department of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints.

Use of dial-up phone lines for PC to PC-type asynchronous communications requires Bell 212A type modems at 300, 1200, or 2400 bps, with either TTY, Hayes Verification, XMODEM, or X.PC protocols.

Internal Disk Files

You can also send transmissions by using the normal text files of the computer you use to create GEDCOM data.

Appendix

GEDCOM TAGS

Introduction

This appendix is a glossary of the tags approved for use with GEDCOM. (See chapter two for the specification for GEDCOM tags.) Every tag must be used as defined to ensure uniformity in the identification of all information transmitted by means of GEDCOM.

The tags are of various types, depending on their role or use in a transmission. They are used to identify individuals, families, names, dates, places, events, roles, sex, sources, relationships, control codes and other kinds of data for computers, computer programs, and computer systems.

The definition for each tag is generally broad enough to cover all uses of the tag. Some tags used for computer programming do not appear in this appendix. For a list of these, contact *Data Administration, Projects and Planning Division, Family History Department, 50 East North Temple Street, Salt Lake City, UT 84150, USA*.

When a new tag is needed, it will be added to the appendix. Suggestions and proposed additions are welcome. Please send them to the address below. Use the form "GEDCOM New Tag Proposal" (PFGS3709) provided at the end of the appendix. Be sure to check the appendix carefully first--the tag in question may already be defined. All GEDCOM tags must be approved by Data Administration in the Projects and Planning Division of the Family History Department. This appendix will be updated from time to time with new, approved tags. Interested individuals may request an update by contacting Data Administration (at the address above).

This appendix consists of two lists. The first list provides the tags in the alphabetical order of their abbreviations, known as "tags" in transmissions. The three-column format includes the tag (abbreviation), the tag name (full name), and the definition.
The second list (see page A-38) specifies the type for each tag and its tag name, but does not include a definition.

Tag	Name	Definition
19D	DUPLICATE_ OVERRIDE	Use as a control tag to identify data entry that tells the program to write a record without doing additional duplicate checking.
ABBR	ABBREVIATION	Used to identify data that is abbreviated: a shortened form of a word or words.